

Activity Guide — senior / module-03-ayurveda-good-health

IKS Curriculum

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Activity 01 — Read an RCT Abstract

Module: Ayurveda (Senior) · **Day:** 4 · **Time:** 15 min within Day 4

Goal

Students read a real peer-reviewed abstract on an Ayurvedic intervention and critique it.

Materials

- Printed abstract: Aggarwal & Harikumar (2009) on curcumin (or substitute another)

Instructions

Read silently. Then answer in your workbook:

1. What's the intervention?
2. What conditions does the abstract cover?
3. What strength of evidence does it claim?
4. What hedge words appear? (“may,” “possibly,” “limited data,” “further research needed”)
5. What would a strong skeptic critique?

Discussion (5 min)

Pair share answers.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Find a related full RCT via Google Scholar; critique sample size, controls, blinding.
- **Tier down:** Focus on Qs 1–3.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Module 3 (Senior)

Type: 5–6 page research-synthesis paper · **Marks:** 65

Topics

Choose one or propose:

1. **A specific intervention** — e.g. “Curcumin’s anti-inflammatory action — what does the evidence say?” or “Triphala for digestive function — review.”
2. **A specific framework claim** — e.g. “Is the Tridosha typology validated by modern biomarker studies?”
3. **A specific convergence** — e.g. “Dinacharya and circadian biology — same insight or convergent inquiry?”
4. **A specific policy question** — e.g. “Should AYUSH practitioners be allowed to prescribe biomedical drugs?”
5. **A specific historical question** — e.g. “Sushruta’s surgical legacy — what specifically did European surgeons learn?”

Required elements

- Clear thesis in opening.
- ≥1 classical primary source (Caraka, Suśruta, Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, BG) — IAST + translation.
- ≥1 peer-reviewed modern empirical study.
- ≥1 historical / scholarly source (Wujastyk, Patwardhan).
- Steel-manned counter-argument.
- MLA or Chicago citations.

Format

5–6 pages, double-spaced, 12pt.

Schedule

- Day 5: topic + thesis.
- Day 8: outline.
- Day 9: draft.
- Day 10: paper submitted.

Rubric

See `rubric.md`.

Self-reflection (1 paragraph)

1. Topic + why.
2. Hardest part.
3. With 3 more days, deeper research on.